



THE GOOD LIFE

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SAVOURING THE SPIRIT OF PORTUGAL

**Visit the Douro Valley, the only
region in the world that can
legally produce port wine**

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

The Douro River Valley, a meandering, terraced region that produces Portugal's beloved port wine, is one of the country's most charming areas. However, unlike the Rhine, Loire and numerous other major rivers in Europe, the Douro has never served as a strategic military site. And so, while driving through the winding roads, you are more likely to come across farms and sleepy villages rather than castles and stony ramparts. In fact, the only thing fortified here is the wine!

But why does wine need to be fortified? Call it a happy accident or necessity being the mother of all inventions, it was originally fortified to prevent it from getting ruined on its arduous journey across the ocean to England. In the